



SmartAutoTech Quick Start Guide

THE 90-SECOND RULE

The Most Important Step in the Diagnostic Process

SmartAutoTech is only as effective as the information it receives.

Before starting a diagnostic session, take approximately **90 seconds** to gather and enter as much information as possible about the vehicle and the concern.

Those 90 seconds can save significant diagnostic time by helping SmartAutoTech quickly narrow the possible diagnostic paths and focus on the most relevant tests.

WHAT IS THE INITIAL DIAGNOSTIC PROMPT (IDP)?

The **Initial Diagnostic Prompt (IDP)** is the first message you enter into SmartAutoTech.

The IDP establishes the starting point for the entire troubleshooting process.

A vague IDP forces SmartAutoTech to consider hundreds of possible causes.

A detailed IDP allows SmartAutoTech to quickly focus on the most likely diagnostic paths.

IDP EXAMPLE

Poor IDP

"Car won't start."

This provides very little information and creates a large number of possible diagnostic paths.

Better IDP

"2018 Ford F-150 5.0L. Cranks but will not start."

This immediately eliminates many possible causes.



Best IDP

"2018 Ford F-150 5.0L. Cranks but will not start. Battery voltage 12.6V. Fuel pump can be heard running. No related DTCs present. Condition started after vehicle sat for two weeks."

This gives SmartAutoTech valuable information that helps narrow the diagnostic process immediately.

INFORMATION TO INCLUDE IN YOUR IDP

Whenever possible, include:

Vehicle Information *(Required)*

- Year
- Make
- Model
- Engine Size

Customer Concern

- What problem is being reported?
- When does the problem occur?
- Is the condition constant or intermittent?

Symptoms Observed

- What is the vehicle doing?
- What is the vehicle not doing?
- Any warning lights?

Scan Tool Information

- Diagnostic Trouble Codes (DTCs)
- Live data abnormalities
- Freeze frame information



Testing Already Performed

- Voltage measurements
- Fuel pressure readings
- Compression readings
- Circuit tests
- Component tests

Recent History

- Recent repairs
- Recent battery replacement
- Collision damage
- Water intrusion
- Vehicle modifications

Additional Observations

- Unusual noises
- Odors
- Environmental conditions
- Customer comments

BEFORE YOU CLICK SUBMIT

Ask yourself:

Have I included:

- ✓ Year, Make, Model, Engine?
- ✓ The exact customer concern?
- ✓ Any DTCs?
- ✓ Tests already performed?
- ✓ Relevant scan data?
- ✓ Recent repairs or vehicle history?
- ✓ Anything unusual I observed?

If the answer is "Yes," you're ready to begin.

WHY THE 90-SECOND RULE WORKS

The goal is not to type more.

The goal is to provide better information.

Better information allows SmartAutoTech to:

- Narrow diagnostic paths faster
- Reduce unnecessary troubleshooting steps
- Recommend more relevant tests
- Improve diagnostic accuracy
- Reduce wasted diagnostic time

REMEMBER

The quality of the troubleshooting process starts with the quality of the **Initial Diagnostic Prompt (IDP)**.

90 seconds of better information can save 30 minutes of diagnostics.

